

CHAPTER FIVE

THE PRELIMINARIES OF A PLAY

The Sages question.

1-4. On hearing the words of Bharata who continued the topic of drama the sages were pleased in mind and said, "We have heard from you about the origin of drama¹ and the Jarjara² as well as [the means of] stopping obstacles³, and the worship of gods⁴. Having grasped the meaning we would like to know in detail (lit. exhaustively), O the very splendid one, about the Preliminaries with all their characteristics ; it behoves you, O Brahmin, to explain [everything] for our understanding [the same properly]."

Bharata answers.

5-6. Hearing these words of the sages Bharata spoke thus about the rules of the Preliminaries : "O the blessed ones, listen to me. I am speaking about the Preliminaries as well as of the Pāda-bhāga¹, the Kalās and the Walking-round² [which relate to them].

Preliminaries defined

7. As it is first performed at the beginning (*pūrvam*) in the stage (*raṅga*) it is called the (*pūrvaraṅga*)¹ Preliminaries.

Parts of the Preliminaries

8-11. Its different parts which are to be performed in due

1-4 (B.G. *same*). ¹ See NŚ. I. 13-18. ² See NŚ. I. 69-73.

³ See I. 54-68. ⁴ See NŚ. III.

5-6 (B.G. *same*). ¹ *pādabhāga*—See NŚ. (C.) XXXI. 308-309. This is a term relating to *tāla*.

² *kalā*—unit of the time measure in music. See NŚ. (C.) XXXI. 608. On this Ag. (I. 211) says : कला इत्येव च सप्तविंश तादृक्कला निष्कृतादिहचक्षते ; तदा सप्तवी मालाव्यवस्थाकलामाहो म्बोतः. ³ *parivarta*. On this see below 23-24, 65-80.

7 (B.G. *same*). ¹ BhP. defines *pūrvaraṅga* as follows : कलापातः पादभागाः प्रविशन्त्येव परिशिः । पूर्वे क्रियन्ते यद्रङ्गे पुरंवरङ्गो भवेदतः (SR. p. 742). The definition in the the comm. of DR. (III. 2) is corrupt. 8-11 (B.G. *same*).

order with the playing of drums and stringed instruments as well as with Recitatives (*pāṭhya*), are as follows: Pratyāhāra¹, Avataraṇa², Ārambha³, Āśrāvaṇā⁴, Vaktrapāṇi⁵, Parighattānā⁶, Saṃghoṭanā⁷, Mārgāsārīta⁸, and Āsārīta⁹ of the long, the medium and the short types. These songs outside [the performance of a play] are to be sung by persons behind the curtain¹⁰ to the accompaniment of drums and stringed instruments.

• 12-15. Then after removing the curtain¹, dances and recitals² are to be performed with the playing of all musical instruments, and some song of the Madraka³ class is to be sung, or one of the Vardhamānaka⁴ class along with the Class Dance [suitable to it] should be applied, Then should take place [one after another] during the Preliminaries the following:— Utthāpāna⁵, Walking round⁶, Benediction⁷, Suṣkāpakṛṣṭa⁸, Raṅga-dvāra⁹, Cāri¹⁰, Mahācāri¹¹, Three Men's Talk¹² and Laudation¹³.

16. I shall now explain in due order the characteristics of all these which are to be included in the ceremony of the Preliminaries.

¹ See below 17.

² See below 18

³ See below 18.

⁴ See below 18.

⁵ See below 19.

⁶ See below 19.

⁷ See below 20.

⁸ See below 20.

⁹ See below 21.

¹⁰ From this statement it appears that the first nine items of the preliminaries were performed on the stage covered with a front curtain much like the modern drop curtain. There were besides this, two curtains on two doors of the tiring room. It seems that the front curtain came into regular use in later times and especially at the end of each act. Cf. *javanī-kāntar* used as a synonym of 'act' in the KM.

12-15 (B.G. *same*). ¹ The front curtain; see 8-11 note 10 above.

² Recitals of the Benediction (*nāṇḍi*) and the Laudation (*prarocanī*) etc. ³ *madraka*—a class of songs.

⁴ *vardhamānaka*—a class of songs with dance. See NŚ. (C.) XXXIX. 224ff. ⁵ See below 22-23. ⁶ See below 23-24, 65-89. ⁷ See below 24-25, 107-113 ⁸ See below 25-26, 113-116, ⁹ See below 26-27.

¹⁰ See below 27-28, 119-120.

¹¹ See below 27-28, 127-130.

¹² See below 28-29, 137-141.

¹³ See below 29-30, 141-142.

16 (B.G. *same*). ¹ It may appear that these items of the Prelimi-

The Pratyāhāra

17. Arranging of the musical instruments (*kuṭapa*) is called the Pratyahāra¹.

The Avataraṇa

The seating of singers is called the Avataraṇa (lit. coming down)².

The Ārambha

18. The commencement of vocal exercise for singing (*parigīta*) is called the Ārambha (lit. beginning)².

The Āśrāvaṇā

Adjusting the musical instruments for playing them in due manner is called the Āśrāvaṇā.

The Vaktrapāṇi

19. Rehearsing (lit. dividing) the different styles (*vr̥tti*) of playing musical instruments is called the Vaktrapāṇi².

The Parighaṭṭanā

The strings of instruments are adjusted duly during the Parighaṭṭanā².

neries to be performed behind the front curtain, have been made needlessly elaborate. But it is not so. In ancient times people due to different conditions of their lives, were not so much punctual in coming to the theatrical show. They did not come to it all at once and at any fixed time. Quite a long time passed before they all assembled. Hence from behind the curtain the Director offered to the early-comers (naturally the people who had no haste in their lives) whatever they could, while preparing for the actual performance. Hence Ag. (I. p. 215) says that nine items of the Preliminaries were meant for a [common] women, children and fools. The same practice about the Preliminaries may be observed even now in case of the Yātrās or the open air theatrical performances in Bengal. 17 (B.G. *same*).

¹ For the arrangement of the musical instruments see the diagram 2.

² For the position of singers see diagram 2.

18 (B.G. *same*). ¹ *āśrāvaṇā*—For details about the performance of this see NŚ. (C.) XXIX. 120 ff.

19 (B.G. *same*). ¹ *vaktrapāṇi*—For details about the performance for this see NŚ. (C.) XXIX. 131 ff.

² *parighaṭṭanā*—For the performance of this see NŚ. (C.) XXIX. 142-145.

The *Samghoṭana*

20. The *Samghoṭana*¹ is meant for rehearsing the use of different hand poses [for indicating the time-beat].

The *Mārgāsārīta*

The playing together [in harmony with one another] of drums and stringed instruments is called the *Mārgāsārīta*².

The *Āsārīta*

21. The *Āsārīta* is meant for practising the beat of time-fractions, (*kalāpāta*)¹.

The Application of songs

And the Application of songs (*gīta vidhi*)² is for singing the glory of gods.

The *Utthāpana*

22-23. I shall now speak about the *Utthāpana* (lit. raising) ceremony which is so styled because from this, the reciters of the Benediction start (lit. raise) first of all in the stage the performance [of the play]. Hence the *Utthāpana* is considered by some to be the beginning [of the performance].

The Walking-round

23-24. The Walking-round (*parivartana*) is so styled because in it, the guardian deities of different worlds are praised [by the Director] walking all over [the stage].

The Benediction

24-25. The Benediction (*nāṇḍi*)¹ is so called because it must always include [and invoke] the blessing of gods, Brahmins and kings.

20 (B.G. *same*). ¹ *samghoṭana*—For the performance of this see NŚ. (C.) XXIX. 137-141.

² *mārgāsārīta*—For the performance of this see NŚ. (C.) XXIX. 145-116.

21 (B.G. *same*). ¹ *āsārīta*—For the performance of this see NŚ. (C.) XXXI. 59-75. 169-194. ² See NŚ. (C.). XXX. 267 ff.

22-23 (B.22-23a, G. 21c-22).

23-24 (B.23b-24a, G.23). ¹ *parivartana*=*parivarta* see below 65 ff.

24-25 (B.24b-25a, G.24). ¹ For its specimens see below 107 ff.

The Śuṣkāvakṛṣṭā Dhruvā

25-26. When an Avakṛṣṭā Dhruvā is composed with meaningless sounds it is called Śuṣkāvakṛṣṭā¹, It indicates verses for the Jarjara².

The Raṅgadvāra

26-27. The Raṅgadvāra is so called, because from this part commences the performance which includes Words and Gestures.

The Cārī and the Mahācārī

27-28. The Cārī is so called because it consists of movements depicting the Erotic Sentiment and in the Mahācārī occur movements delineating the Furious Sentiment.

The Three Men's Talk

28-29. The conversation of the Director (*sūtradhāra*), an Assistant (*pāripārśvaka*) and the Jester¹ is called the Three Men's Talk (*trigata*).

The Laudation

29-30. The address which the Director (lit. the expert) makes suggesting the Denouement of the action (*kārya*) of the play in hand with [proper] reasoning and arguments is called the Laudation (*prarocanā*).

The origin of the Bahirgīta and its justification

30-31. I shall now describe in detail the Āśrāvāṇā which is included in the Bahirgīta and shall speak of its origin as well as its justification.

25-26 (B.26, G.25). ¹ see below 113-115.

² The meaning is not clear. B.G. read between 25b and 26a two prose lines.

26-27 (B.27, G.26). 27-28 (B.28 G.27).

28-29 (B.29, G.28). ¹ The Jester's role is assumed by one of the Assistants. See below 70 where two Assistants enter along with the Director. For details of the Three Men's Talk see below 137-141.

29-30 (B.30, G.29). ¹ For details about the Laudation see below 141-142;

31-32. Now when songs in seven forms¹ and in *Citra*² and *Dakṣiṇa*³ *Mārgas* together with the *Upohana*⁴ and the *Nirgita*⁵ were started by musical experts like *Nārada* in praise of gods, all the gods and the *Dānavas*, in the assembly were made to hear the *Nirgita*⁶ performed with proper tempo and time beat⁷.

Daityas and *Rākṣasas* provoked to jealousy

. 33-34. Now on hearing these happy songs praising the gods, the *Daityas* and the *Rākṣasas* were all provoked to jealousy.

34-36. Under these circumstances they pondered [over the matter] and said to one another : "We are glad to hear (lit. accept) this *Nirgita* in accompaniment of the instrumental music, (and not the songs) in seven forms¹ about the exploits of the gods, which they were pleased to hear ; we shall hear the *Nirgita* only and shall always be pleased with it. Then these *Daityas* [and *Rākṣasas*] pleased with the *Nirgita* urged for its repeated performance".

The gods approach *Nārada* to stop the *Nirgita*.

37-38. This enraged the gods who said to *Nārada*, "These *Dānavas* and *Rākṣasas* are pleased with the *Nirgita* only [and do not want anything else i.e. songs]. Hence we wish this performance (of the *Nirgita*) to come to an end. What do you think of this ?"

30-31 (B.31, G.30).

31-32 (B.32-33, G.31-32). ¹ Seven forms means the types of *tālas*.
See NŚ. (C.) XXXI. 497 ff. ² See (C.) XXXI. 414.

³ See (C.) XXXI. 412.

⁴ See (C.) XXXI. 234 ff.

⁵ Another name for *bahirgita*. See below 33-42.

⁶ *nirgita*—instrumental music.

⁷ For different aspects of the *tāla* see NŚ. (C.) XXVIII. 15-16 and (C.) XXXI.

33-34 (B.34, G.33).

34-36 (B.35-37a, G.34-36a). ¹ The seven forms—On this *Ag.* (1. p. 224) says : पातवस्तौविशेषाह्निविशेषसंयोगा ईश्वरः रक्षसा अहृतविशेषः क्रमैव अहृतः स्वर्गता विहारमन्त्रादिभिरुक्तं यथापातवत् समीक्ष्यतः.

Nārada pacifies the gods.

38-41. Hearing these words of the gods Nārada replied, "Let the Nirgīta dependent on the music of stringed instruments be not stopped, and this (*nirgīta*) combined with the Upohana and accompanied by the music of stringed instruments will have seven forms. Enraptured (lit. bound down) by this Nirgīta the Daityas and the Rākṣasas will not be provoked and they will not create any obstruction [of the performance]."

41-42. This is the called Nirgīta to satisfy the vanity of the Daityas while in honour of the gods it is called the Bahirgīta.

42-44. This is to be played by experts in the Citravīṇā¹ with metallic strings, and the performance should contain light and heavy syllables (*akṣara*)² and have Varṇas³ and Alamkāras⁴. It is called the Nirgīta because in it there is sung a combination of sounds carrying no sense, and to satisfy the jealousy of the gods it is called the Bahirgīta".

The gods are pleased with the Nirgīta (Bahirgīta).

44-45. The reason behind the Nirgīta in its seven forms as well as the Utthāpana and the like, will now be given.

45-54. The Pratyābhāra pleases the Rākṣasas (Yātudhāna) and the Pannagas, while the Apsarasas are delighted with the Avataraṇa. The Gandharvas are pleased when the Ārambha is performed, and in the performance of the Āśrāvaṇā the Daityas take delight. The Vaktrapāṇi pleases the Dānavas and in the Parighaṭṭanā the hosts of Rākṣasas are [again] pleased. By the Saṃghoṭanā Guhyakas are satisfied, while the Mārgāsārīta the pleases Yakṣas. When

37-38 (B.37b-38, G.36b-37).

38-41 (B.39-41, G.38-40).

41-42 (B.42, G.41).

42-44 (B.43-44, G.42-43). ¹ *citravīṇā*—*nāṭyoparañjanārthā yā vīṇā*; a kind of *vīṇā* suitable for being played during the performance of a drama. ² Syllables like *ghṛī* and *dr̥ṇī* are heavy, and syllables like *ma*, *la*, *ka*, *ṭa* are light. ³ See NŚ. (C.) XXIX. 19-23.

⁴ See NŚ. (C.) XXIX. 24-75.

44-45 (B.45, G.44).

45-54 (B.54b-55, 46-53, G.45-53).

songs (*gītaka*) are sung the gods enjoy them, and Rudra with his followers is pleased by the performance of the Vardhamāna. Similarly in the performance of the Walking-round (*parivartana*) Lokapālas (the guardians of the worlds) are delighted, and the Moon-god is pleased with the Benediction. During the singing of the Avakṛṣṭā (Dhruvā) Nāgas are pleased, while Śuṣkāvakṛṣṭā (Dhruvā) pleases the host of Pitṛs (ancestors). In the Raṅgadvāra Viṣṇu is pleased, while the Jarjara, ceremony pleases the leaders of Vighnas. On the Cārī being performed Umā takes pleasure while on the performance of Mahācārī the Bhūtas are delighted.

55. So much about worshipping the deities in different parts of the Preliminaries (*pūrvaraṅga*) beginning with the Pratyāhāra and ending in the [Mahā] cārī.

56. O the best of Brahmins, in course of describing the different parts of the Preliminaries I have named the gods pleased by them and mentioned [the individual] parts of it in which they take delight.

57-58. The performance of the Preliminaries which means worshipping the gods, is praised by them (*i.e.* gods) and is conducive to duty (*dharma*), fame and long life. And this performance whether with or without songs, is meant for pleasing the Daityas and the Dānavas as well as the gods (lit. denizens of the celestial region).

59. I shall now tell you [afterwards] while discussing the rules of Dhruvās¹ the characteristics and function of performances with or without songs (*sagīta* and *nirgīta*) as well as of the Vārdhamāna.²

55 (B.56, G.54).

56 (B.57, G.55).

57-58 (B.58-59, G.56-57).

59 (B.61, G.59). ¹ See NŚ. (C.) XXXII.

² Before this couplet (59) B. reads one additional śloka (B. 60).

The songs in the pure Preliminaries

60-63. After performing the songs (*gītaka*)¹ and the Vardhamāna², one should sing the Utthāpani (Raising) Dhruvā³ which has in its feet of eleven syllables the first two, the fourth, the eighth and the eleventh as long. It should be [sung in] the Caturasra (Tāla)⁴ and [should consist of] four feet and four Sannipatas⁵ as well as three kinds of tempo (*laya*)⁶ and three cæsura⁷ (*yati*). Besides this it should consist of four Walking-rounds (*parivarta*) and of three Pāṇis⁸, and it should be in the Viślokā⁹ metre and in the same kind of Tāla.

64. The Tāla in question should consist consecutively of Śamyā¹ of two Kalās, Tāla of two Kalās, Śamyā of one Kalā and Sannipāta of three Kalās. *

The First Walking-round

65. Thus a Sannipāta Tāla of eight Kalās should be observed by the experts. And it is said that a Walking-round is made up of four such Sannipātas.

66. The first Walking-round in the Preliminaries should be made in slow tempo (*sthitalaya*) and on the termination of the third Sannipāta in it (*i.e.* the first *parivarta*) drums should be played.

The second Walking-round

67. On the termination of the first Walking-round the second one (*i.e.* Walking-round) having commenced in medium

60-63 (B.62-65, G.60-63). ¹ See NŚ. (C.) XXXI. 267 ff.

² See NŚ. (C.) XXXI. 225 ff.

³ The term *utthāpani dhruvā* does not occur in the *Dhruvādhyāya* NŚ. (C.) XXXII. ⁴ See NŚ. (C.) XXXI. 9-11.

⁵ See NŚ. (C.) XXXI. 38-39.

⁶ See NŚ. (C.) XXXI. 4.

⁷ See NŚ. (C.) XXXI. 532-537.

⁸ Ag. explains three *pāṇis* as *samapāṇi*, *avara-pāṇi* and *uparipāṇi*.

⁹ See NŚ. (C.) XXXII. 149.

64 (B.66, G.64). ¹ Cf. NŚ. (C.) XXXI. 74.

65 (B.67, G.65).

66 (B.68, G.66).

67 (B.69, G.67).

tempo (laya) the Director [and the two Assistants]¹ should enter [the stage].

68-69. The three should simultaneously enter [the stage] with handfuls of flower-offering. But before that they should get themselves purified, initiated and furnished with charms for protection [against evil spirits]. They should be clad in white, and flowers carried by them should [also] be white, and they should be looking with the Adbhuta glance ¹ and be in the Vaiṣṇava Sthāna² with Sauṣṭhava of the body.

70. The two¹ Assistants (*pāriṣārāvika*) should carry a golden pitcher (*bhaṅgāra*) and the Jarjara, and with them by his side the Director should put forward five steps.

71. These five steps [will be] for the purpose of worshipping Brahman, and the manner of putting them forward will be described [below] in detail.

72. They should slowly place their two feet three Tālas¹ apart and then raise [them one by one] on each side and again put them down at the same [distance].

73. After going five steps¹ in the manner described above the Director and his two Assistants (lit. others) should perform the Sūci Cāri with left foot moved first and the right foot afterwards.

74. Then the Director should offer flowers in Brahman's circle (*Brāhma-maṇḍala*) which is another name for the centre of to stage where the deity is supposed to be present.

¹ Entrance of the two Assistants is implied in this passage. See below 68-69.

68-69 (B.70-71, G.68-69). ¹ See NŚ. VIII. 48. ² See NŚ. XI. 50-52.

70 (B.72, G.70). ¹ One of the Assistants is to assume the role of the Jester in the Three Men's Talk. See above 28-29, 137-141.

² *Jarjara*— see NŚ. III, 73 ff.

71 (B.73a, G.71). ¹ B. omits 71b.

72 (B.74, G.72). ¹ *tāla*—a unit of length. The distance from the tip of the middle finger to the wrist. See NŚ. III, 21 note.

73 (B.75, G.78). ¹ B. *viṣṇuupadi* for *pañcapadi*. 74 (B.76, G.74).

75-77. And afterwards he (*i.e.* the Director) should respectfully bow to Brahman (lit. Pitāmaha) with Lalita gesture,¹ and to measure the length of time during the salutation he should thrice touch the ground with his hand, and his steps should be [suitably] divided. The second Walking-round which begins with the entrance of the Director and ends² with the salutation [to Brahman] and use of gestures [related to it], should be performed in medium tempo (*lāya*).

The third Walking-round

77-78. Next during the third Walking-round (*parivarta*) the Director should go round the Brahman's circle (*i.e.* the centre of the stage), perform Ācamana and take up the Jarjara. [The manner of taking it up is as follows:]

78-80. Rising up quickly from [Brahman's] circle (*maṇḍala*) he should perform the Sūci (lit. Vedha) Cāri with this foot (*i.e.* the right foot) put forward first and the left foot afterwards. And then he should again raise his right foot which was on the side and perform the Sūci (Vedha)¹ Cāri putting forward the left foot first and the right foot afterwards.

80-83. Going round [the centre of the stage] the Director should call the person (*i.e.* one of the Assistants) who carries the golden pitcher (*bhṛṅgāra*).¹ and perform ablution (*śauca*) [with water from this vessel]. He should then perform Ācamana and sprinkle himself with water in due order. Thus after performing properly the ablution the Director should carefully take up the Jarjara, the destroyer of obstacles, and this act should be performed along with the beginning of the last Śannipāta [of this second Walking-round].

83-84. The third Walking-round beginning with going

75-77 (B.77-79a, G.74c-76). ¹ See NŚ. IX. 201. B reads *vandanābhī-nayānugah* for *°nayāntakah*.

77-78 (B.79, G.77).

78-80 (B.80-81, G.78-79). ¹ According

to Ag. (I. p. 233) *Vedha* = *Sūci Cāri*.

80-83 (B.82-84, G.80-82). ¹ See above 70.

83-84 (B.85, G.88).

round the centre of the stage (i.e. *Brāhmamaṇḍala*)¹ and ending with the taking up of the Jarjara should be performed in a quick tempo.

The fourth Walking-round

84-87. After taking up the Jarjara to ward off evils he should mutter [some Mantras] in eight Kalās. Then he should perform the Sūci (Vedha) Cāri by putting forward the left foot first and the right foot afterwards, and then, move five steps towards the musical instruments. And then again he should observe the Sūci (Vedha) Cāri by putting forward the left foot first and the right foot afterwards. The fourth Walking-round which begins with the taking up of the Jarjara and ends¹ with an approach to the musical instruments should be made in a quick tempo.

87-88. In this [*pūrvaraṅga* which is of the Caturasra type] movements of hand and feet in it will occupy sixteen Kalās while it being of the Tryasra type such movements will occupy Twelve Kalās only.

88-89. [The Director and the two Assistants] should make three salutations by touching the ground, with the hand and before this they are to sprinkle themselves with water, but in case of the Tryasra [Preliminaries such sprinkling] has not been prescribed¹.

The Parivartanī Dhruvā

89-90. In this manner they should perform the Utthāpana (lit. raising). Then comes the Parivartanī (Walking-round) Dhruvā

¹ See NS. III, 23-30 note.

84-87 (B.86-88, G.84-86). ¹ B. reads *kutaḥo nigamāntakaḥ*.

87-88 (B.89, G.87).

88-89 (B.90, G.88). ¹ This and the preceding (87-88) passage should properly go after NS. 64 for they relate to the Utthāpana which should come before the Walking-round ; see before 22-23.

89-90 (B.91, G.89). ¹ For *caturasre*, B. G. *caturasram*.

which should be performed in the Caturasra (Tāla) and medium tempo and with eight Sannipātas.

90-91. The Dhruvā (song) which has only the last syllable long in its four feet of eleven syllables, is called the Parivartant (Walking-round) Dhruvā.

91-92. During the singing of this Dhruvā the Director should move leftwards¹ in the Vārtika Mārga with graceful step in accompaniment of instrumental music and should bow to [different] deities in directions belonging to them.

92-93. And during the foot movement [mentioned above] each step of the Director should consist two Kalās, and movement in each direction should consist of two Sannipātas.

93-94. Then he would observe the Sūci (Vedha) Cāri putting forward the left foot first and the right foot afterwards and putting the latter at a distance of two Tālas.

94-95. In this manner he should go five steps with the Atikrāntā Cāri¹ and bow to different deities in directions belonging to them.

95-97. First of all he should bow to the eastern direction presided over by (Śakra) Indra, secondly he should bow to the southern direction belonging to Yama. Thirdly he should bow to the western direction ruled by Varuṇa. Fourthly he should bow to the northern direction of which Dhanada (Kuvera) is the protector.

97-98. After bowing to these directions he should perform the Sūci Cāri putting forward the left foot first and the right foot afterwards and begin the Walking-round.

98-99 Then with his face towards the east the Director

90-91 (B.92, G.90).

91-92 (B.93, G.91). ¹ *vāmakena (vārtikena, B).*

92-93 (B.94a, G.92). ¹ B. omits 93a.

93-94 (B.94b-95a, G.93).

94-95 (B.95b, G.94). ¹ See NŚ. XI. 29.

95-97 (B.96-97, G.95-96).

97-98 (B.98, G.97).

98-99 (B.99, G.98).

should bow to Śiva (Rudra), Brahman and Viṣṇu (Upendra) while going forward three steps by 'masculine', 'feminine' and 'neuter' feet [one after another].

99-100. The right foot is 'masculine' and the left foot is 'feminine' while the right foot not [much] raised is called 'neuter'.

100-101. Śiva (Iśa) should be bowed to with the masculine foot [put forward first] while in bowing to Brahman the neuter foot [should be so put forward]¹.

The Fourth Man enters.

101-102. The Walking-round should be [finished] thus, and then the Fourth Man (*caturtha-kāra*) should duly enter [the stage] with flowers [in his hands].

102-103. And he should duly offer Pūjā to the Jarjara and to all the musical instruments (*kutapa*) as well as to the Director.

103-104. His foot-movements during the Pūjā should be made to accompany the playing of drums, and there should be no song sung then, but only meaningless syllables should be chanted (*stobhakriyā*).

Singing of the Avakṛṣṭā Dhruvā

104-105. After offering the Pūjā the Fourth Man should make his exit. And then should be sung an Avakṛṣṭā Dhruvā¹ in Caturāśra (Tāla) and slow tempo (*sthita-laya*).

105-106. This Dhruvā should abound in heavy syllables and depend on the Sthāyi-varṇa¹ and be made up of eight Kalās, and its Tāla should be Avapāṇika.

99-100 (B.100, G.99).

100-101 (B.101a-102b, G.100). ¹ B. repeats here 90-91.

101-102 (B.103, G.101).

102-103 (B.104, G.102). ¹ See NŚ. III, 11-13.

103-104 (B.105, G.103).

104-105 (B.106, G.104). ¹ One of the six kinds of *Dhruvās*. See NŚ. (C.) XXXII. 154-159.

105-106 (B.107, G.105). ¹ See NŚ. (C.) XXIX. 21.

106-107. The *Avakṛṣṭā Dhruvā* is a song consisting of four feet of ten syllables of which the fourth, the fifth, the seventh and the eighth will be short.¹

The Benediction

107-108. Then the Director will recite in a medium (*madhyama*) tone the Benediction which should consist of eight or twelve feet (*pāda*).¹

108-109. (These are the specimens of Benediction) :

namo'stu sarvadevebhyo
dvijātibhyaḥ śubhaṃ tathā |
jitaṃ somena vai rājñā
ārogyaṃ bhoga eva ca ||

Tr. Salutation to all the gods. Blessed be the twice born class. May Soma the king attain victory as well as healthy life and [earthly] enjoyment.¹

109-110. brahmottaraṃ tathāivāstu
hatā brahmadviṣas tathā |
praśāstvimāṃ mahārājaḥ
pṛthivīm ca saśāgarām ||

Tr. Let there be an advancement of the cause of the Brahmins, and let their enemies be killed, and let the great king rule this earth together with all the seas.

110-111. rāṣṭraṃ pravardhatām caiva
raṅgaś cāyam samṛdhyatām |
prekṣākartur mahān dharmo
bhavatu brahmabhāvitah ||

Tr. Let this state prosper, and this theatre flourish and let

106-107 (B.108). ¹ G. omits this.

107-108 (B.109, G.106). ¹ For different interpretations of *pāda* see Lévi, pp. 132-133, II. 25-26. Rāghavabhaṭṭa quotes from Ag. in his *Śākuntalāṭīkā* (p. 6) the following : पदानि द्योकावयवभूतानि निडकाणि सुबकाणि or द्योकावयवभूतानि or द्योकावयवभूतानि वा and द्योकावयवभूतानि वा. These passages do not occur in the published *Abhinavabhāratī*.

108-109 (B.110, G.107). ¹ See Lévi, p. 133.

109-110 (B.111, G.108). 110-111 (B.112, G.109).

the producer of the theatrical show attain virtues proceeding from the Vedic knowledge.

111-112. *kāvyakartur yaśaś cāstu*
dharmaś cāpi pravardhatām |
ijyayā cānayā nityam
priyantām devatā iti ||

Tr. Let the playwright (lit. writer of the *kāvya*) attain fame and let his virtue increase, and by this kind of sacrifice (*yajña*), let the gods be always pleased with him.

112-113. After the recitation of each of such Benedictory poems the two Assistants should loudly and distinctly say, "Let this be so."

The Śuṣkāvakṛṣṭā Dhruvā

113-114. The Benediction should thus be performed duly according to the rules [mentioned above]. Then should be sung the Śuṣkāvakṛṣṭā Dhruvā and verses praising the Jarjara.

114-115. This Dhruvā should consist of nine long syllables first and then six short syllables followed by three long syllables, *e.g.*

115-116. *digle digle jhaṇḍe jhaṇḍe jam*
bu ka va li ta ka te te jā.

The Raṅgadvāra

116-118. After properly performing the Śuṣkāvakṛṣṭā Dhruvā, he (the Director) should recite in a loud tone one Śloka in adoration of the deity in course of whose worship [the dramatic performance is going to be held], and then [another Śloka] paying homage either to the king or to the Brahmins should be sung.

118-119. After reciting the Jarjara Śloka in what is called the Raṅgadvāra (lit. entry into the performance) he should again read another Śloka to honour the Jarjara¹.

111-112 (B.113, G.110).

112-113 (B.114, G.111a).

114-115 (B.116, G.113).

116-117 (B.117b-118a, G.115).

118-119 (B.119b-120a, G.117).

113-114 (B.115, G.112).

115-116 (B.117a, G.114).

117-118 (B.118b-119a, G.116).

¹ Mss. reading is *jarjarasya vināśana*

The Cāri

119-120. And after the Jarjara has been honoured,¹ he should perform a Cāri and the two Assistants should step backwards.

120-121. Then the Additā Dhruvā¹ should be performed with the medium tempo (*laya*), Caturasra Tāla and four Sannipātas.

121-122. The Dhruvā (song) which has the first, the fifth and the last syllables long and the remaining syllables short in all its four feet of twelve syllables, is called the Additā.

122-123. I shall relate its application according to the procedure adopted by Śiva (Maheśvara) and Umā when performing it in the past with [the display of] different States (*bhāva*) and movements.

123-125. After assuming the Avahittha Sthāna (posture),¹ and placing the left hand [first] with its palm downwards on the navel and taking up the Jarjara by his other hand,² the Director should go five steps, with his left hand showing the Pallava gesture; and while going he should cover one Tāla at each step and move his limbs gracefully³.

125-127. Afterwards he should perform the Sūci Cāri by putting forward his left foot first and the right foot afterwards. Then the Director (lit. the expert one) should recite a Śloka with love as its subject-matter. And after reciting this Cāri Śloka and

(*vinamana*). But this gives no relevant meaning. We emend it to *jarjarasya vinamanam*.

119-120 (B.120b-121a, G.118). ¹ Read *mūṇayitā* (B.G. *nāṇayitā*).

120-121 (B.121b-122a, G.119). ¹ See below 121-122, also NŚ. (C.) XXXII. 10, 357.

121-122 (B.122b-123a, G.120). 122-123 (B.123b-125a, G.121).

123-125 (B.124b, 125b, 126, G.122-123). ¹ Defined in NŚ. XIII. 164. 165. ² Mss. read *tuladhṛtam*. But its meaning is not clear. It is just possible that the original reading has been changed. We therefore emend this to *taladhṛtam* meaning 'held in palm' or 'held by hand.'

³ B. reads between 123b and 124a an additional homistich.

125-127 (B.127-128, G.124-125).

performing the Walking-round, he should with his face towards the front withdraw backwards with steps described before.

The Mahācārī

127-128. And after placing the Jarjara in the hands of one of the Assistants he should perform the Mahācārī in accordance with the rules laid down below.

128-130. During this Cārī the Dhruvā song should be of the Caturasra type and in quick tempo, and it should have four Sannipātas and eight Kalās. This Dhruvā song should have feet of eleven syllables of which the first, fourth, seventh, tenth and the last are long and the remaining ones short.

130-131. (An example of the Caturasra Dhruvā) :

pādatalāhati-patita-śailam
kṣobhita-bhūta-samagra-samudraṁ ।
tūṇḍava-nṛttam idam pralayānte
pātu harasya sadā sukhadāyī ॥

Tr. Let the ever-pleasing Class Dance of Hara (Śiva) after the destruction of the world, which smashed the hills by the impact of his feet and agitated the ocean with all creatures living in it, always give you protection.

130-131. Then he should step towards the drums (*bhāṇḍa*) and afterwards perform the Sūci Cārī followed by a change of the Vikṣepa.

132-133. Afterwards he should move his feet gracefully with a quick tempo, and keeping them three Tālas apart, he should go five steps. There again he should perform the Sūci (Vedha) Cārī with his left foot put forward first and the right one afterwards.

134-135. And with the foot movement [described above] he should move backwards with his face towards the front, and again he should go three steps forward in a similar manner, and then he

127-128 (B.129, G.126).

128-130 (B.130-131, G.127-128).

130-131 (B.132, G.129).

131-132 (B.133, G.130).

132-133 (B.134-135a, G.131-132a).

134-135 (B.135b-136, G.132b-133).

should again perform the Sūci Cāri with his left foot put forward first and the right foot afterwards.

136-137. Then he should recite a couplet calling up the Furious Sentiment while bringing his feet together, and then after going three steps he should call for the two Assistants, and on their coming up, a Narkuṭaka Dhruvā should be sung. At the time of singing this Dhruvā he should perform the Sūci (Vedha) Cāri by putting forward the left foot first and the right foot afterwards.

The Three Men's Talk

137-138. Then in case of a play in the Verbal Style (*bhā-rati vr̥tti*) the Three Men's Talk (*trigata*) should take place. During it (this Talk) the Jester should suddenly come in and deliver a discourse consisting mostly of irrelevant words to excite the smile of the Director,

138-139. In this discourse should be brought in some controversial topic with an abrupt remark or an enigmatical utterance [of some kind], and questions such as who is [there] and who has won, leading to the plot of the play (lit. the poem), but no unpleasant topic should be brought in.

140-141. In the Three Men's Talk an Assistant talks with the Jester who finds fault with his words which are, [however,] supported by the Director.

The Laudation

141. Then the Director (lit. an expert) should put in the Laudation and the Invitation [to members of the audience], and for the success of the performance (lit. the stage) the subject of the play should again be mentioned.

142. After putting into practice all these rules, all the three persons (i.e. the Director and the two Assistants) should perform

136-137 (B.137-138a, G.134-135a).

137-138 (B.138b-139a, G.135b-136a).

138-139 (B.139b-140, G.136b-137).

140 (B.141, G.omits).

141 (B.142, G.138).

142 (B.143, G.139).

the *Sūci* (*Vedha*) *Cāri*, and they should go out together while performing any *Cāri* other than the *Āviddha* one.

The Tryasra Preliminaries

143-144. Thus, O Brahmins, should be performed the Preliminaries of the Caturasra type ; now I shall speak of that of the Tryasra type. Its use is similar and its component parts are the same ; the only feature that distinguishes it from the Caturasra one is its abridged measure of *Tāla*.

145-146. [In it] the *Śamyā* should consist of two *Kalās* and the *Tāla* of one *Kalā*, and again the *Śamyā* is to consist of one *Kalā* and the *Śannipāta* of two *Kalās*. With this kind of measurement of *Kalā*, *Tāla* and tempo, should be performed the Tryasra Preliminaries which include the *Utthāpana* and such other items.

147. The *Dhruvā* (song) which has the fourth, the eighth, the tenth and the last syllables long in all its four feet of twelve syllables, is called the *Utthāpana Dhruvā* of the Tryasra (type).

148. In the Tryasra Preliminaries an expert dancer should abridge the instrumental music, movements [of persons], *Dhruvā* songs and their *Tāla*.

149. The actions and movements [of a dancer] are to be made of two types—elaborate and abridged—according as the instrumental and vocal musics are such.

150-151. It is said that each movement of hands and feet should be of two *Kalās*' duration, and in any Walking-round in the Caturasra (Preliminaries) the hands and feet should be moved sixteen times, while in the Tryasra Preliminaries they are to move only twelve times.

151-152. This is the measurement of both (*i.e.* of hand and foot movements) in the Preliminaries. But in the Walking-round, the foot movement should consist of three steps only, but in bowing

143-144 (B.144-145, G.140-141).

145-146 (B.146-147, G.142-143).

148 (B.149, G.145).

150-151 (B.151-152a, G.147-148a).

151-152 (B.152b-153, G.148b-149).

147 (B.148, G.144).

149 (B.150, G.146).

to [the different] directions in the Caturasra Preliminaries one should go five steps.

153. [But all these matters] should be performed in the Tryasra Preliminaries according to the measure of Tāla as the master of the art thinks fit. Hence to avoid repetition no [elaborate] direction about the same has been given [here].

154. O the best of the Brahmins, thus should be performed the pure Preliminaries of the Caturasra and the Tryasra types, which relate to a play depending on the Verbal Style.

The Mixed Preliminaries

155. So much about the pure Preliminaries which I was to describe. I shall now tell you how the producers may turn them to one of the mixed (*citra*) type.

156-157. After the Utthāpani (Raising) Dhruvā has been decorated with flowers given by the Fourth Man (*caturthakārā*) and resounded with the well measured loud songs of musical experts, Dundubhis should be played again and again.

158. [And in the mixed Preliminaries thus begun] clusters of white flowers should be scattered all over [the stage], and the Aṅgahāras should be performed by [dancers dressed as] goddesses.

159-160. The Class Dance which has been described above with its [Piṅgīs], Recakas, Aṅgahāras, Nyāsas and Apanyāsas should intervene the separate feet of the Benedictory (*nāṇḍi*) poems (*pada*). This rule should be put into practice by those who would turn pure Preliminaries into mixed ones.

161. After the 'pure' Preliminaries have been duly made 'mixed' [all the dancers dressed as] goddesses should make their exit.

162. After the exit of all the female dancers the other parts of the Preliminaries should be performed.

153 (B.154, G.150).

155 (B.156, G.152).

158 (B.159, G.155).

161 (B.162a, 163a, G.158).

154 (B.155, G.151).

156-157 (B.157-158, G.153-154).

159-160 (B.160-161, G.156-157).

162 (B.163b-164a, G.159).

163. This is the manner in which the pure Preliminaries should be changed into mixed ones. But in the Preliminaries, be they of any type, there should not be too much dance and song.

164. If [in a performance] songs, music and dance continue for too long [a time] they tire out the artists as well as the spectators.

165. Tired [persons] can neither attain or help to attain a clear impression of the Sentiments and the States, and because of this the rest of the performance (*i.e.* of the play itself) cannot excite pleasure.¹

166. After performing the Preliminaries, be they Caturasra or Tryasra of the pure or mixed type, the Director along with his Assistants should make their exit from the stage¹.

Introduction of the play

167. After the Preliminaries have been duly performed¹ in the manner described, the Introducer (*sthāpaka*)² should enter [the stage] and he should resemble the Director (*sūtradhāra*) in every respect (lit. in quality and form).

163 (B.164b-165a, G.160).

164 (B.165b-166a, G.161).

165 (B.166b-167a, G.162). ¹ B. reads one additional couplet after this.

166 (B.168b-169a, G.163). ¹ B. reads three additional couplets (B. 169b-172a) after this.

167 (B.1 2b-173a, G.164). ¹ The reading *prajujya* in this passage seems to be defective; for the nominative to this *prajujya* cannot be *sthāpaka* (Introducer). Dhanañjaya (c. 10th century) clearly says that the *sūtradhāra* (the Director) having gone out after the Preliminaries (*pūrvavāṅga*), another actor enters to introduce the drama (III. 2). The same is the opinion of Śāradātanaya (c. 1175-1250). See the BhP. p.228, lines 56. Viśvanātha also expressed a similar opinion. See the SD. VI. 26. Hence this passage should be construed somewhat like the well-known proverb *rathe ca vāmanam dṛṣṭvā punarjanma na vidyate*. It seems that Bhāsa cut down the Preliminaries and made an end of the practice of getting the play introduced by the *sthāpaka*. This assumption will explain why Bāṇa wrote *sūtradhāra-kṛtārambhaiḥ* etc. (Harṣaścarita, Introduction, 15).

² Ag. says *sūtradhāra eva sthāpakah*, cf. note 1 above.

168. He should assume the Vaisṇava Sthāna (posture)¹ and the Sauṣṭhava² of the body, and on entering the stage he should observe the foot movements which the Director had used.

169. At the entrance of the Introducer the Dhruvā should be made suitable to the occasion (lit. meaning) and it will be either Caturasra or Tryasra and be in medium tempo.

170. Then he should perform a Cāri in praise of gods and Brahmins in accompaniment with the recitation of Ślokas containing sweet words and evoking various Sentiments and States.

171. After thus pleasing the spectators (lit. the stage) he should announce the name of the play-wright (lit. the poet), and then he is to start the Prologue (*prastāvanā*) which relates to proclaiming the theme of the play (lit. the poem)¹.

172-173. Then by mentioning (lit. having recourse to) a god in a divine [play], a man in a human [play] and a god or a man in [a play] where gods and men [meet, he] should proclaim in different ways the subject of the play [lit. the poem] by variously alluding to its Opening (*mukha*) and Germ (*bija*)¹.

174. After introducing the play the Introducer (lit. the Brahmin who makes the introduction of the play) should go out [of the stage]. Thus should be performed the Preliminaries according to the rules.

175. If any producer of a play will perform the Preliminaries according to the rules laid down, nothing inauspicious will happen to him and he will [after his death] reach the heavenly region.

176. [On the contrary] whoever produces a play in an willful violation of the rules [in this matter] will sustain great loss and will [after his death] be reborn as a creature of a lower order.

168 (B.173b-174a, G.165). ¹ See XI. 50-51. ² See XI. 89b, 91a.

169 (B.174b-175a, G.166). 170 (B.175-176a, G.167).

171 (B.176b-177a, G.168). ¹ B. reads one additional hemistich.

172-173 (B.178-179, G.169-170). ¹ See SD. VI. 27. also DR. III. 3.

174 (B.180, G.171). 175 (B.181, G.172).

176 (B.182, G.173).

177. Fire fanned by a strong wind does not burn [anything] so quickly as does the wrongly made production.

178. In this manner the Preliminaries of two different extents (*pramāṇa*) should be performed by the people of Avanti, Pañcāla, Dākṣiṇātya and Oḍra regions.

179. O Brahmins, these are the rules regarding the Preliminaries. Tell me what other rules relating to the Nāṭyaveda should be discussed now¹.

Here ends Chapter V of Bharata's Nāṭyaśāstra
which treats of the Preliminaries to the production of a play.

177 (B.184, G.175).

178 (B.184, G.175).

179 (B.185, G.176). ¹ The portion of this chapter after this *śloka* has not been translated. It is not from the hand of author of the NŚ.